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SUPERSEDING
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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FRAMES, PRINTING, VACUUM

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers vacuum printing frames, with and without integral light source, for the preparation of lithographic press plates.

1.2 Classification.- The vacuum printing frames shall be of the following types, styles, class, subclass, sizes, and arc controls as specified (see 6.2 and 6.3).

Type I - Hinged frame assembly

Style 2 - Wall mounting, manual vacuum controls

Class 1 - Horizontal exposure
Class 2 - Vertical exposure, size 30 by 32 inches

Style 3 - Floor stand

Class 1 - Open sides

Size - 28 by 36 inches minimum exposure area

Subclass 2 - Automatic vacuum controls

Type II - Elevating frame assembly, floor stand, automatic vacuum controls

Size - 22 by 26 inches minimum exposure area
Size - 30 by 40 inches minimum exposure area
Size - 48 by 60 inches minimum exposure area

Type IV - Pivoting hinges frame assembly, cabinet base carbon arc light source, manual vacuum controls

Size - 30 by 40 inches minimum exposure area

Arc control - Automatic
Arc control - Motor driven

FSC 3610

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

CC-M-636	-	Motors, Fractional Horsepower, (Alternating Current).
DD-G-451	-	Glass, Plate, Sheet, Figured (Float, Flat, For Glazing, Corrugated, Mirrors and Other Uses).
MMM-A-260	-	Adhesive, Water-Resistant, For Sealing Waterproofed Paper.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	-	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-1055	-	Barrier Material, Waterproofed, Flexible.
PPP-C-650	-	Crates, Wood, Open and Covered.
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, For Sealing and Securing.

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MIL-C-104	-	Crates, Wood, Lumber and Plywood Sheathed, Nailed and Bolted.
MIL-P-116	-	Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-B-121	-	Barrier Material, Greaseproofed, Waterproofed, Flexible.
MIL-T-152	-	Treatment, Moisture and Fungus Resistant, of Communications, Electronics and Associated Electrical Equipment.
MIL-P-514	-	Plates, Identification, Instruction and Marking, Blank.
MIL-L-10547	-	Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	-	Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property.
MIL-STD-461	-	Electromagnetic Interference Characteristics, Requirements for Equipment.
MIL-STD-462	-	Electromagnetic Interference Characteristics, Measurement Of.

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(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications.- The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

NATIONAL FIRE PROTECTION ASSOCIATION (NFPA)

Standard No. 70 - National Electrical Code

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Fire Protection Association, 60 Batterymarch Street, Boston, Massachusetts 02210.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC.,

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Trucking Associations, Attn: Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 202, Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard product.- The vacuum printing frames covered by this specification shall be the regular commercial product of the manufacturer, except for changes necessary to comply with specification requirements. All vacuum frames of the same type, class, style, size, subclass, and arc control, as applicable, furnished under any one contract or purchase order, shall be identical throughout, including parts and assemblies thereof.

* 3.2 First article.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a preproduction sample of the required vacuum printing frame shall be made available to the contracting officer, or his authorized representative,

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for approval in accordance with 4.2. Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsiblity for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilites to be used for manufacture of the production item.

* 3.3 Materials and components.- Materials and components not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer for vacuum printing frames, provided the completed item complies with all provisions of this specification.

3.3.1 Threaded fasteners, washers, and rivets.- Threaded fasteners, washers, and rivets shall be standard commercial items made from materials which are inherently resistant to corrosion, or shall be coated to resist corrosion.

* 3.3.2 Glass, vacuum frame.- Vacuum frame glass shall conform to type I, class 1, silvering quality of DD-G-451. The glass shall be not less than 1/4 inch thick and of length and width as required to insure compliance with 3.4.1. All corners shall be square. The cut edges shall be free from chips, cracks, or other imperfections that may damage mating parts.

* 3.3.3 Rubber blanket.- The blanket shall be 2-or 3-ply reinforced rubber with a corrugated, gridded, or grooved work contact surface. The surface depressions shall be not less than 1/32 inch deep and spaced not less than 5 per inch. The plate accommodation area of the blanket shall be surrounded by an integrally molded, vulcanized or cemented on beading of a uniform cross sectional shape and size. One or more grooved vacuum exhaust ports shall be incorporated within the plate accommodation area adjacent to the beading.

* 3.3.4 Vacuum pump, rotary, motor driven.- The vacuum pump shall be a rotary vane type driven by an integrally connected or shaft coupled constant speed motor. The vacuum pump and motor shall be completely equipped with all necessary fittings including filter, oiler, muffler, and on types I and II vacuum printing frames, a 9 foot, 3-conductor, rubber covered, "heavy duty" cord fitted with a soft rubber or armored type standard 3-blade male plug.

* 3.3.4.1 Vacuum pump motor.- The vacuum pump motor shall conform to the applicable requirements of CC-M-636, for 1725 rpm motors. When fungus and moisture resistance is required (see 6.2), the motor shall be treated in accordance with the applicable requirements in CC-M-636.

3.3.4.2 Manual vacuum controls.- Manual vacuum controls for type I, style 2, and type IV machines shall consist of a vacuum gage, a vacuum intake and release valve, necessary mounting and connecting fittings, and electrical controls.

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* 3.3.4.2.1 Electrical controls.- The electrical controls for the vacuum pump motor shall consist of a toggle type "off-on" switch and a reset type thermal overload compatible with the pump motor. At the supplier's option the thermal overload may be a part of the toggle switch or located on the pump motor housing.

* 3.3.4.2.2 Additional manual vacuum controls.- Additional vacuum controls with required fittings, shall be incorporated in the vacuum line to permit operation of alternate vacuum equipment not a part of the vacuum printing frame assembly.

* 3.3.4.3 Automatic vacuum controls.- Automatic vacuum controls for type I, subclass 2, and type II machines shall consist of controls specified in 3.3.4.2 and 3.3.4.2.1 and additional controls as hereinafter specified.

3.3.4.3.1 Pneumatic vacuum control switch.- An adjustable pneumatic control switch, shall be incorporated in the control system. The switch shall be adjustable with graduated dial markings for 0 to 30 inches of mercury, numbered every 5 inches, and shall have an "on-off" differential between 2 and 4 inches of mercury. The switch contacts shall be snap acting and rated for an inductive load in excess of the motor requirements.

3.3.4.3.2 Vacuum reservoir.- The required vacuum reservoir shall have a minimum capacity of 500 cubic inches. The reservoir may be an integral part of the vacuum frame supporting structure.

3.3.4.3.3 Check valve.- A vacuum line check valve having an operating differential not exceeding 1 inch of mercury shall be incorporated between the vacuum pump and vacuum reservoir. The check valve shall be provided with an externally mounted filter having a "see through type" housing. The filter assembly shall be removable for cleaning without the need for tools.

3.3.4.4 Vacuum lines and fittings.- The vacuum line and all fittings (other than the gage line) shall be a minimum of 1/8 inch standard pipe size. Connecting hose shall be at least 3/8 inch rated size, 2 ply fabric reinforced rubber vacuum hose. Screw type hose connections shall be provided at all hose joints. When the vacuum pump is not attached directly to the frame assembly supporting structure, not less than 12 feet of vacuum hose shall be provided to permit convenient placement of the pump on installation.

* 3.4 Design.- The vacuum printing frames shall have a glass carrying frame and a spring loaded rubber blanket carrying frame mounted on a metal supporting structure. The frames shall be furnished complete with all necessary fittings and appurtenances.

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3.4.1 Size.- The minimum effective exposure area shall be as specified under size in 1.2. The plate accommodation area inside the beading of the blanket shall not exceed the specified size by more than 2 inches in each dimension. The vacuum frames shall have a thickness capacity to accommodate negatives, press plates, and other similar materials, in varying thicknesses up to at least 1/4 inch (see 4.4.3).

* 3.5 Construction.-

3.5.1 Sheet metal components.- All like bends of sheet metal components shall be of uniform radius. Embossing, when applicable shall be produced by a method that shall insure uniformity of size and shape. All exposed sheet metal edges shall be free of sharp edges and burrs.

3.5.2 Riveting.- When riveting is employed rivets shall be as specified in 3.3.1. Rivet holes shall be a diameter to insure a snug fit with the rivet shank after setting. Burrs at rivet holes that may prevent proper seating of rivet heads, shall be removed. Setting of rivets shall be accomplished so that mating surfaces are drawn tight. Rivets shall not have any splits, burrs, or sharp edges.

3.5.3 Welding.- The surface of parts to be welded shall be clean and free from scale, paint, grease, and foreign matter. Welds shall be uniformly run without voids. All welding scale and flux shall be removed after welding has been accomplished. All projections and rough edges shall be dressed smooth. Spot welds, when utilized, shall be sound and smooth, with no pits or flashes.

3.5.4 Threaded connection.- Threaded connections shall be made using washers and threaded fasteners in accordance with 3.3.1. Threads shall not be peened, staked, or otherwise deformed to prevent disassembly.

* 3.5.5 Electrical.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the types I and II vacuum printing frames shall be suitable for operation on 120 volt, 60 Hertz, single phase power source, and type IV vacuum printing frames shall be suitable for operation on 120/208, 3-phase, 4-wire, 60 Hertz power source.

* 3.5.5.1 Wiring.- Electrical wiring shall be accomplished in accordance with the applicable provisions of the National Electrical Code (NFPA No. 70). Acceptable evidence of meeting this requirement may be the manufacturer's certified statement that the electrical system conforms to NFPA No. 70 (see 4.3.4).

* 3.5.5.2 Moisture and fungus resistance.- When specified (see 6.2), the electrical system shall be treated to resist fungus growth and moisture by a type I or II treatment conforming to MIL-T-152.

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* 3.5.5.3 Electromagnetic compatibility.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), equipment procured under this specification shall conform to the class IIB requirements of MIL-STD-461 (see 4.4.5).

* 3.6 Detail requirements.-

* 3.6.1 Frame assembly.- The glass carrying frame and blanket carrying frame shall each be fabricated from rectangular steel tube or formed or structural metal shapes. Any open ends shall be closed by butt welding to produce continuous, single piece frames. Both frames shall be parallel with each other when placed together prior to clamping.

* 3.6.1.1 Glass carrying frame.- The glass carrying frame shall be fitted with glass, specified in 3.3.2 and retained under the frame by means of continuous retaining strips secured to the bottom surface of the frame. Insulating strips shall be provided between the retaining strips, glass, and frame to prevent glass breakage from strains encountered in use and during transportation. The glass shall be removable without the need for tools other than commercially available screwdrivers or wrenches.

* 3.6.1.2 Blanket carrying frame.- The blanket carrying frame shall be fitted with a blanket, as specified in 3.3.3, secured along the bottom surface of the frame by mechanical means and maintained in an elevated position in order to reduce to a minimum the volume of air to be evacuated in the closed vacuum frame assembly. The blanket shall be removable for replacement without the need for tools other than commercially available screwdrivers or wrenches.

* 3.6.2 Type I, hinged frame assembly.- The glass carrying frame and blanket carrying frame specified in 3.6.1 through 3.6.1.2, shall be hinged together along the long dimension by not less than 2 steel hinges. The frame assembly shall be mounted in the applicable supporting structure specified herein.

* 3.6.2.1 Hinged frame assembly lock mechanism.- The frames hinged as specified in 3.6.2 shall be retained in the closed position by a manually operated clamping device to seal the frames together. The clamping device shall be located on the long dimension of the lower frame on the operators side, opposite the hinged side. Means shall be provided for adjusting the takeup of the hinged frames, to compensate for any permanent set or deformation of the blanket beading. With the assembled frames opened, the clamping mechanism attached to the lower frame shall not project above the blanket height and that portion attached to the upper frame shall not project below the bottom surface of the upper frame.

* 3.6.2.2 Lifting handle.- The upper frame shall be fitted with a lifting handle, or handles, located along the long dimension of the frame, on the operators side.

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* 3.6.2.3 Hold-open device.- The upper frame shall be equipped with a hold-open device capable of supporting the upper frame in the open position at an angle of 60 to 70 degrees from the lower frame. The device shall be of the self locking metal bracket type, counter balance type, or a combination of both. The device shall not interfere with accessibility to operating controls.

* 3.6.2.4 Style 2, wall mounting, manual vacuum controls.- Style 2 frames shall be for wall mounting. The vacuum frame assembly, specified in 3.6.1 through 3.6.2.3 shall be mounted on a supporting structure consisting of a welded structural steel frame provided with a minimum of six 3/8 inch diameter wall mounting screw holes. The vacuum frame assembly shall be attached, along the hinged side, to the supporting structure. Attachment shall be by hinges secured with socket type alloy steel cap screws, in accordance with 3.3.1, not less than 5/16 inch diameter or, alternatively, attached to a steel shaft supported on the structure. The vacuum frame assembly thus supported shall be capable of tilting through 90 degrees from horizontal to vertical.

* 3.6.2.4.1 Vertical position catch.- The vacuum frame assembly shall be secured in the vertical position by snap acting or spring loaded brackets or catches attached to the assembly and supporting structure.

* 3.6.2.4.2 Bumpers, vertical position.- The vacuum frame assembly shall be secured in the vertical position against felt or rubber bumpers to prevent free motion of the assembly when so positioned.

* 3.6.2.4.3 Counterbalance.- The frame assembly, hinged to the supporting structure, shall be equipped with a spring type counterbalance to facilitate tilting of the frame assembly from the horizontal to vertical position.

* 3.6.2.4.4 Vacuum pump and controls.- The vacuum pump and controls shall be for manual operation and shall conform to 3.3.4.4, and 3.3.4 through 3.3.4.2.2. All operator controls shall be compactly and conveniently mounted on a framed panel or housing attached to the supporting structure. The vacuum pump shall be provided with the appropriate devices for wall mounting.

* 3.6.2.4.5 Class 1, horizontal exposure.- Class 1 vacuum frames shall be arranged to rest on a bench top or table for loading and exposure and raised to the vertical position for storage.

* 3.6.2.4.6 Class 2, vertical exposure.- Class 2 vacuum frames shall be arranged for horizontal loading and lowered to the vertical position for exposure and storage. The horizontal position of the frame assembly shall be

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secured by telescoping steel brackets and automatic latching and releasing dogs. A 3/8 inch thick plywood or fiberboard cover with spring latches shall be provided to protect the glass stored in the vertical position. The vacuum frame supporting structure shall not exceed 36-1/2 inches in overall width and 38 inches in overall height.

* 3.6.2.5 Style 3, floor stand.- Style 3 vacuum frames shall have the hinged frame assembly attached to a metal base frame designed to support the frame assembly in the horizontal loading and vertical exposure position. The assembled unit shall be capable of passing through a door opening 32 inches wide, without the need for disassembly or upending. Means shall be provided to allow rotation of the frame assembly through 90 degrees from the horizontal to vertical position. Direction of rotation shall be accomplished in a manner that when in the vertical exposure position the glass faces away from the operator. The axis of rotation shall be located so that the frame assembly shall tend to rest in the horizontal and vertical positions by gravity. To insure against accidental tilting, locking devices, capable of withstanding the test in 4.4.2.3, shall be provided to maintain the frame assembly in either position against positive stops. In addition, an interlocking safety device shall prevent tilting the hinged frame assembly to the vertical position when the upper and lower frames are not locked together. When in the horizontal loading position the blanket of the frame assembly shall be not less than 36 inches nor more than 42 inches above the floor.

* 3.6.2.5.1 Counterbalance.- The frame assembly, hinged to the supporting structure, shall be equipped with a counterbalance to facilitate tilting of the frame assembly from the horizontal to vertical position.

* 3.6.2.5.2 Vacuum pump and controls.- The base stand shall include a shelf or other equally satisfactory means for mounting the vacuum pump and motor specified in 3.3.4 and 3.3.4.1. All operator controls shall be compactly and conveniently mounted on a front framed panel or housing, or attached to the right hand side of the base frame.

* 3.6.2.5.2.1 Automatic vacuum controls.- Automatic vacuum controls shall conform to the applicable requirements in 3.3.4.3 through 3.3.4.4.

* 3.6.2.5.3 Class 1, open sides.- Class 1 vacuum frames shall have the supporting structure completely open, without a base inclosure. Removable, ball bearing type casters, with steel wheels, shall be provided under the extremities of the supporting structure. In addition, not less than 3/8 inch diameter holes shall be incorporated in the base of the supporting structure to permit bolting to floor surfaces.

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3.6.3 Type II, elevating frame, floor stand, automatic vacuum controls.- Type II vacuum frames shall consist of an assembly of mating frames as specified in 3.6.1 through 3.6.1.2, mounted on a supporting structure. The mating frames shall be separated by elevating the upper frame parallel to the lower frame to permit access to the lower frame from all sides. When closed and locked together, the frames shall be capable of rotation as a unit from the horizontal to vertical positions.

3.6.3.1 Supporting structure.- Removable ball bearing type casters, with steel wheels, shall be provided under the extremities of the supporting structure. Screw type leveling pads with locknuts or self locking threads shall be provided in the caster mounts or adjacent thereto. The leveling pads shall have sufficient adjustment to permit elevating the unit at least 1/2 inch above the caster supported height, and shall be retractable to clear the floor a minimum of 1/2 inch, when the unit is caster supported.

3.6.3.1.1 Uprights and base assembly.- The uprights and base assembly shall be bolted together with pin or key location guides, to permit partial disassembly if necessary for passage through a 32 inch wide door opening at time of installation.

3.6.3.1.2 Axial shafts.- Axial shafts for rotation of the mating frame assembly shall be securely fixed to the supporting structure uprights. The shafts shall be of sufficient size to withstand shock loads in movement without bending or fracture. The shaft location shall be such that the blanket carrying frame, in the horizontal position, shall be not less than 38 nor more than 40 inches above the floor surface.

* 3.6.3.1.3 Upper and lower frames, assembly.- Separation of the upper and lower frames shall be actuated by a handwheel or crank control for parallel movement, and shall raise and lower along guide rails. The elevating movement of the upper frame shall be not less than 30 inches. It shall be possible to rotate the blanket frame independently of the elevated glass carrying frame, for convenient access to the underside of the elevated glass frame for cleaning. No projections shall extend between the frames when open. When the upper frame is lowered it shall engage a locking device to secure upper and lower frames in alignment for rotation. The mating frames shall be locked for vacuum application by a single control device to mechanically secure the 2 frames together. Locking brackets, or a spring plunger lock shall be mounted on the supporting structure to maintain the frame assembly in the horizontal loading position. Vertical exposure position shall be maintained by gravity or automatic latches.

3.6.3.2 Vacuum pump and controls.- The vacuum pump and controls shall be automatic and shall conform to the applicable requirements of 3.3.4 through 3.3.4.4. The vacuum pump and controls shall be securely mounted on the supporting structure. The operator controls shall be located on an inclosed panel or housing located at a convenient height for right hand operation.

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* 3.6.4 Type IV, pivoting hinged frame assembly, cabinet base carbon arc light source, manual vacuum controls.- The type IV vacuum frames shall consist of an assembly of mating frames designed for loading with the glass upright, and to pivot 180 degrees for exposure to the cabinet base carbon arc light source. The blanket and glass frames shall conform to the applicable requirements in 3.6.1 through 3.6.2.3. The assembled frames shall be interconnected to the cabinet base by means of cabinet mounted pivot bearings engaging pivot pins secured midway along opposing sides of the blanket frame. Positive acting stops shall be provided for both loading and exposure positions (see 4.4.2.3). The vacuum system shall conform to 3.3.4.4, and 3.3.4 through 3.3.4.2.2, and shall be mounted in the cabinet base. The cabinet shall be inclosed on all sides and shall have access doors, panels, or drawers for access to components subject to periodic adjustment, service, cleaning, or replacement.

* 3.6.4.1 Cabinet base light source.- The cabinet base light source shall include a reflector system to insure uniform distribution of the carbon electrode arc lighting over the entire effective exposure area of the vacuum frame. An automatic timing device shall be incorporated in the operator's control panel to open the arc lamp circuit at the expiration of any predetermined setting of time. The timing device shall be calibrated in minutes and seconds up to 5 minutes, and shall be capable of being reset for an additional exposure period.

* 3.6.4.1.1 Carbon electrode feed mechanism.- The carbon electrode feed mechanism shall be automatic or motor driven, as specified (see 3.6.4.1.2, 3.6.4.1.3, and 1.2). The mechanism shall advance the electrodes proportionately to their consumption by the arc, and shall regulate the gap to provide optimum illumination, and shall insure that the electrodes are coaxially aligned at all times with the arc gap in the focal point of the reflector. The mechanism shall provide automatic striking of the arc when the arc is broken, and shall overcome and compensate for such conditions as small electrode impurities or current fluctuations.

* 3.6.4.1.2 Automatic carbon arc control.- The electrode gap for automatic arc control systems shall be automatically adjusted at controlled intervals, to compensate for consumption of the electrodes during operations.

* 3.6.4.1.3 Motor driven arc control.- The electrode gap for motor driven arc control systems shall be maintained by a magnetic amplifier device which activates a motor to provide for continuous automatic adjustment of the electrode gap, to compensate for consumption of the electrodes during operation.

* 3.6.4.1.4 Illumination.- The intensity of illumination on the blanket at any one point shall not vary more than 10 percent from the average light intensity at that point during the life of a single pair of electrodes (see 4.4.4.2). The intensity of light at any point on the blanket shall not deviate more than plus or minus 15 percent from the average illumination of the blanket (see 4.4.4.1).

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* 3.6.4.1.4.1 Electrode life.- The life of a pair of electrodes shall be not less than 2 hours, at which point in time the difference in length between electrode stubs shall be not more than 3/4 inch (see 4.4.4.3).

* 3.6.4.2 Cooling system.- A forced air cooling system shall be incorporated in the cabinet base, and shall operate throughout the carbon arc illumination cycle. This system shall draw ambient air through cabinet louvres and shall exhaust through a blower duct at the rear of the cabinet.

* 3.6.4.3 Operator controls.- All operator controls, including a pilot light, shall be located on the front panel of the cabinet for ready access to the operator.

* 3.7 Lubrication.- All moving parts, requiring periodic lubrication, shall be fitted with the appropriate lubrication fitting for the type lubricant required. Lubricants required shall be available through commercial sources and shall be identified by commercial nomenclature and designations. Before delivery to the Government, the end item shall be serviced with grades of lubricants designed for use in the temperature range of plus 50 F. to 125 F. After lubrication the equipment shall be conspicuously tagged to indicate the temperature range and commercially identifiable designation of the lubricants used.

3.8 Performance characteristics.-

3.8.1 Environmental.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the vacuum printing frames shall be capable of satisfactory performance, without failure or evidence of deterioration, after storage at minus 80 F. to plus 160 F. (see 4.4.1).

3.8.2 Rigidity of assembly.- The end item shall be sufficiently rigid to withstand operation on uneven floors without evidence of malfunction, misalignment, or binding of any component or assembly (see 4.4.2.2).

3.8.3 Manually controlled vacuum printing frames.- The vacuum system for manually controlled units shall be air tight so that a vacuum of 25 inches of mercury can be obtained within one minute, and shall maintain this vacuum with a leakage not to exceed 5 inches of mercury in 5 minutes when tested in accordance with 4.4.3. In addition, metallic press plates shall remain in absolute contact with the glass during tests.

3.8.4 Automatically controlled vacuum printing frames.- The vacuum system for automatically controlled units shall be air tight so that a vacuum of 25 inches of mercury can be obtained within one minute, and the vacuum retained with the motor off, with a leakage loss not to exceed 5 inches of mercury in 30 minutes, when tested in accordance with 4.4.3. In addition, metallic press plates shall remain in absolute contact with the glass surface during tests.

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3.9 Finish.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the finish shall be in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice. All painted and plated surfaces shall be smooth, uniformly coated, and free from runs, wrinkles, orange peel, teardrops, grit, sags, areas of thin or no film, chalking and flaking.

3.10 Marking.-

3.10.1 Marking for identification.- Identification marking of the end item shall conform to the unit marking requirements of MIL-STD-130, and shall appear on an attached plate conforming to MIL-P-514.

3.10.2 Instruction plates.- The end item shall be equipped with instruction plates, or plate, noting any special warnings, cautions, or special procedures to be followed in operating the unit. The plates shall be of the same material as plates specified in 3.10.1.

3.11 Technical publications.- A technical manual shall be furnished with each end item. Manual contents and distribution shall be as specified (see 6.2).

* 3.12 Workmanship.- The end item shall be free of dents and fractures, and shall show no evidence of warping or misalignment. There shall be no loose, misplaced or missing components. All fastening devices shall be drawn tight. All functioning components shall operate as intended without binding or excessive looseness. All rough and sharp edges shall be removed. Electrical wiring shall be mechanically secure at terminals, with adequate slack to prevent strain.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article inspection.- When a preproduction sample is required, it shall be examined for the defects listed in table I, the dimensions specified, and tested in accordance with 4.4.1 through 4.4.5, as applicable. The presence of any visual defect, any dimension not within the specified requirements, or failure to pass the tests shall be cause for rejection of the preproduction sample.

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* 4.3 Inspection.- Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

* 4.3.1 Component and material inspection.- In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards, unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

* 4.3.2 Process inspection.-

4.3.2.1 In-process examination.- Examination shall be made at appropriate stages of manufacture to determine compliance with requirements in table I.

TABLE I.- In-process examination

Requirement	Paragraph Reference
Moisture and fungus resistance treatment, when applicable	3.5.5.2
Cutting of glass	3.3.2
Riveting	3.5.2
Welding	3.5.3

* 4.3.3 End item inspection.- The lot shall be all completely assembled vacuum printing frames of one type, style, class, subclass, size, and arc control as applicable offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely assembled vacuum printing frame.

* 4.3.3.1 Visual examination.- Examination shall be made of the completely assembled vacuum printing frames for defects classified in table II. The inspection level shall be level II. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE II.- Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Finish	Not finished as specified	X	
	Painted finish not smooth, uniformly coated, and free from runs, wrinkles, orange peel, teardrops, grit, sags, or areas of thin or no film		X
	Component or assembly that is painted or otherwise coated, affecting serviceability		X
* Design	Not specified type, style, class, subclass and size required, as applicable	X	
	Not specified method of arc control (applicable to type IV only)	X	
Construction and workmanship	Part or component missing or not specified type	X	
	Fractured, split, punctured, dented, bowed, malformed, or otherwise impaired	X	
	Sheet metal bend not uniform		X
	Embossing not uniform size and shape		X
	Misplaced, loose, or not in proper alignment	X	
	Sharp burr, sliver, or splinter that may cause injury to personnel	X	
	Operation omitted or not properly performed	X	
	Adjustable assembly that cannot be adjusted	X	
	Adjustable assembly not properly adjusted to perform the function intended		X
	Functioning component that requires abnormal force to operate		X
	Component not readily accessible for servicing where required		X

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TABLE II.- Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Welding and brazing (where required)	Missing, incomplete, burn holes, cracked, fractured, or otherwise not fused	X	
	Slag inclusion, undercut, not smooth and uniform, scale or flux deposits not removed		X
	Projections and rough edges not removed		X
Soldering (when applicable)	Missing, not adherent or incomplete	X	
	Not clean (flux or flux residue not removed), not smooth or pin holes in solder		X
Bolts, nuts, screws, studs, and other types of fasteners	Missing, broken, stripped, split, burr, fractured, or loose		X
	Peened or staked (threaded fastener)		X
Electrical assembly	Wiring cut, abraded, not properly joined, loose at terminal, or not inclosed in specified conduit, when required	X	
	Adequate slack not provided for wiring to release strain or excessive insulation stripped from wiring		X
Lubrication (where applicable)	Not lubricated where required	X	
	Insufficiently lubricated		X
	Not specified type	X	
Switches, meters, gages and valves	Missing not properly calibrated, not specified capacity or type, or otherwise defective	X	
Assembly	Component not properly located, assembled, or secured	X	
	Assembly warped, sprung, or out of alignment	X	

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TABLE II.- Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Marking for identification	Missing, incomplete, not legible, not specified type or size, not in proper location, not affixed in the prescribed manner, not correct color, plate, label or tag not fabricated of the specified material, not stenciled, stamped, embossed, printed, lithographed, et cetera whichever required		X
Technical manuals	Missing, incomplete, not legible		X

4.3.3.2 Dimensional examination.- Inspection shall be made to determine compliance with dimensions specified. Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 6.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

* 4.3.3.3 Testing of the end item.- When a preproduction sample is not required, the initial production unit shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1, and 4.4.4 through 4.4.5, when applicable. Failure to pass any test shall be cause for rejection of the lot. In addition, production units shall be tested as specified in 4.4.2 through 4.4.3, using inspection level S-4 and an AQL of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

* 4.3.4 Code and standards compliance.- Proof of compliance with NFPA No. 70 shall be made available to the Government representative (see 3.5.5.1).

* 4.3.5 Examination of preparation for delivery.- An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packaging, packing and marking as required by section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be as indicated in table III. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be all of the containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE III.- Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defect
Markings, Exterior and interior	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Preservation	Preservative improperly applied or missing.
Materials	Component missing or damaged or otherwise defective.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as detached components not cushioned, contents not adequately anchored, loose strapping or inadequate stapling.

4.4 Test mehtods.-

4.4.1 Environmental.- When applicable (see 3.8.1), and prior to other tests specified hereinafter, the completely assembled unit shall be stored in an ambient temperature of minus 80 F., ± 5 F., for 72 hours and then returned to plus 70 F. ± 10 F. for 4 hours. The unit shall then be stored in an ambient temperature of plus 160 F., ± 5 F., for 4 hours and then returned to room temperature.

4.4.2 Mechanical operation.-

* 4.4.2.1 Hold-open device, types I and IV hinged vacuum frame assembly.- The hinged frame assembly of types I and IV vacuum printing frames shall be opened and closed at least 20 times. The upper frame shall remain open for not less than 15 seconds without manual aid during each cycle, to determine adequacy of the hold-open device specified in 3.6.2.3. During conduct of the test, a check shall be made of the fully open angle and for accessibility to operating controls. Failure of the frame to remain open without manual aid, at an angle of 60 to 70 degrees, shall constitute failure of this test. Any blockage or obstruction of operating controls shall also constitute failure of this test.

* 4.4.2.2 Rigidity of assembly, types I, II, and IV vacuum printing frames.- Elevate one corner of the base 1/2 inch above the floor and operate all functioning components, including the vacuum pump and carbon arc lamps (when applicable) at least 20 times to determine compliance with 3.8.2. Any evidence of misalignment, breakage, or malfunction of any component or assembly shall constitute failure of this test.

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* 4.4.2.3 Tilt lock, Types I and IV vacuum printing frames.- The action of the hinged frame tilt locks shall be tested by applying a 50 lb. load against the action of the tilt lock for both loading and exposure positions. Placement of the load shall be such as to take maximum advantage of leverage in an attempt to overcome the tilt lock. Failure of this test shall be evident if the applied load overcomes the action of the tilt lock (see 3.6.2.5 and 3.6.4).

* 4.4.3 Vacuum testing.- Manually and auotmatically controlled units shall be set up for operation in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations. A metallic press plate, not less than 20 by 25 by 0.012 inch, shall be positioned on the blanket and over the vacuum exhaust port. The upper and lower frames shall then be closed for vacuum application. The system shall then be exhausted to a vacuum of 25 inches of mercury. On manually controlled units, close the bleeder valve, clamp the hose near the pump and switch the vacuum pump motor off. On automatically controlled units, switch the vacuum pump motor off. Failure to obtain a reading of 25 inches of mercury within one minute, shall constitute failure of the test (see 3.8.3 or 3.8.4). Any leakage exceeding 5 inches of mercury in 5 minutes for manually controlled vacuum systems, and leakage exceeding 5 inches of mercury in 30 minutes for automatically controlled vacuum systems, shall also constitute failure of the test. After successful completion of the above test, the units shall be retested with the metallic press plate centrally located on the blanket over sufficient equivalent size paper packing to total 1/4 inch thickness (see 3.4.1). Any evidence of failure to maintain the plate in absolute contact with the glass shall constitute failure of this phase of the test.

* 4.4.4 Illumination, Type IV vacuum printing frames.- The test may be conducted with the glass and blanket frame assembly removed. Light measurements shall be taken with a foot candle illumination meter equipped with a probe sensitive to both visible and ultraviolet light. Readings shall be taken with the probe at normal blanket height, and supported by a glass identical to the vacuum frame glass.

* 4.4.4.1 Overall illumination.- Light meter readings shall be taken with the probe in the center, at each corner, and at the midpoint of each side of the plane surface at blanket height. The nine readings shall be averaged. A deviation of any one reading in excess of 15 percent of the average for the nine readings shall constitute failure of this test (see 3.6.4.1.4).

* 4.4.4.2 Localized illumination.- Readings shall be taken at the nine points specified in 4.4.4.1. Five reading periods for each reading point shall be spaced at uniform intervals for 2 hours. Each period shall consist of readings taken every minute during a 10 minute period. A deviation of any one reading in excess of 10 percent of the average of all readings at that point, shall constitute failure of this test (see 3.6.4.1.4).

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* 4.4.4.3 Electrode life.- Electrode life shall be determined in conjunction with the test in 4.4.4.2. Failure of the arc during the 2 hour test, or a difference in length between the two electrode stubs in excess of 3/4 inch, after the 2 hour test, shall constitute failure of this test (see 3.6.4.1.4.1).

* 4.4.5 Electromagnetic compatibility.- When electromagnetic compatibility is required, the preproduction sample or initial unit of production shall be tested by the supplier in accordance with Test Methods CE03 and RE02 of MIL-STD-462. The Government reserves the right to witness tests performed by the supplier or his private testing organization. The supplier shall furnish the contracting officer for approval, the Interference Control Plan, the EMI/EMC Test Plan, and the Electromagnetic Compatibility Test Report required in MIL-STD-461. Upon approval of the test report by the contracting officer, and provided all other requirements of the specification are met, the preproduction sample, or initial unit of production, as applicable, shall be used as a model for all production units (see 3.5.5.3).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging.- Preservation and packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.-

5.1.1.1 Disassembly.- Projecting detachable components shall be detached from the vacuum printing frame in order to reduce cube and prevent damage while in transit.

5.1.1.2 Cleaning.- All exposed, uncoated ferrous metal surfaces of each vacuum printing frame shall be cleaned process C-1 of MIL-P-116 and thoroughly dried.

* 5.1.1.3 Preservation .- All contacting surfaces of each vacuum printing frame (surfaces that contact other surfaces in operation), cleaned as specified, shall be coated with type P-7 preservative of MIL-P-116. All noncontacting surfaces (surfaces that do not contact other surfaces in operation), cleaned as specified, shall be coated with type P-1 preservative of MIL-P-116. Surfaces coated with type P-7 preservative, from which preservative might be removed by contact with packaging and packing materials, shall be covered, wrapped, or bagged with greaseproof barrier material conforming to type I or II, grade A of MIL-B-121. Barrier material shall be secured with twine made of jute, sisal, manila, or cotton, or with tape conforming to type III, grade A of PPP-T-45, or heat sealed when heat-sealable barrier material is used.

5.1.1.4 Glass carrying frame.- The glass carrying frame shall be protected in such a manner as to prevent breakage while in transit.

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* 5.1.1.5 Components.- Detached components and miscellaneous hardware shall be packaged in a fiberboard box or boxes conforming to type CF, variety SW, or type SF, class domestic, grade 275, style optional of PPP-B-636. Fiberboard inserts or other cushioning material shall be used as necessary to isolate and immobilize the contents. Each box shall be securely closed.

5.1.1.6 Dials and switches.- Projecting dials and switches on the control panel of vacuum printing frames shall be covered with cellulosic cushioning material secured in place with pressure sensitive adhesive tape or cotton cord or twine.

5.1.1.7 Technical publications.- Technical publicatons, when applicable, shall be packaged in a sealed polyethylene bag and secured to the vacuum printing frame.

* 5.1.2 Level C.- Vacuum printing frames shall be preserved and packaged to afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration, and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.- Each complete vacuum printing frame, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a cleated plywood or nailed wood shipping container conforming to overseas type, type 3 load of PPP-B-601, or class 2, style 2 or 4, type 3 load of PPP-B-621, except that weight limitations of the container specification shall not be exceeded; or in a crate conforming to type I, class 1 or 2, style a of MIL-C-104. The fiberboard box or boxes containing components shall be placed in an unused portion of the shipping container. The contents of each shipping container shall be anchored in accordance with the appendix of MIL-C-104. Cleated plywood and nailed wood shipping containers shall be waterproofed, as specified in 5.2.1.1 and when gross weight exceeds 250 pounds, shall be provided with skids in accordance with the applicable container specification. The side and end panels of nailed wood shipping containers shall be provided with diagonals in accordance with PPP-B-621 when the inside depth of the container exceeds 36 inches. Each shipping container shall be closed, and strapped in accordance with the applicable container specification or appendix thereto.

* 5.2.1.1 Waterproofing.- Each cleated plywood or nailed wood shipping container shall be provided with a type I or II, grade C case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Alternatively, the contents of cleated plywood and nailed wood shipping containers which have been provided with skids, shall be waterproofed with a full height shroud made of waterproof barrier material conforming to class E-2, H-1, H-5, or M-1 of PPP-B-1055. All seams of the shroud shall be sealed with a 3/4 inch minimum width continuous seam of water-resistant adhesive conforming to MMM-A-260.

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* 5.2.2 Level B.- Each complete vacuum printing frame, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a cleated plywood or nailed wood shipping container conforming to domestic type, style A or B of PPP-B-601, or class 1, style 2 or 4, type 3 load of PPP-B-621 or in a crate conforming to PPP-C-650. The weight and dimensional limitations of the applicable container specification shall not be exceeded. The fiberboard box or boxes containing components shall be placed in an unused portion of the shipping container. The contents of each shipping container shall be anchored in accordance with the appendix of PPP-C-650. Each cleated plywood or nailed wood shipping container exceeding 250 pounds gross weight shall be provided with skids in accordance with the applicable container specification. The side and end panels of nailed wood shipping containers shall be provided with diagonals in accordance with PPP-B-621 when the inside depth of the container exceeds 36 inches. Each shipping container shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix of the applicable container specification.

5.2.3 Level C.- Vacuum printing frames, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The vacuum printing frames are intended for use in the preparation of lithograph press plates and other photographic materials on shore based, van mounted, and shipboard installations.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, style, class, size, subclass, and arc control required as applicable (see 1.2).
(c) First article.- When a preproduction sample is not required (see 3.2).
(d) When fungus and moisture resistance is required (see 3.3.4.1 and 3.5.5.2).
(e) Electrical power source characteristics, when other than specified (see 3.5.5).
(f) When electromagnetic compatibility is not required (see 3.5.5.3).
(g) When storage conditions in 3.8.1 are not required (see 3.8.1).
(h) Finish requirements, if other than specified (see 3.9).
(i) Manual contents and distribution (see 3.11).
(j) Selection of applicable levels of preservation, packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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6.3 Deletion.- The vacuum printing frames indicated below, and covered in MIL-F-3724C, have been deleted in this revision since the items are no longer required.

(a) Type I, style 3, class 1, size 26 by 36 inches, subclass 1.
(b) Type I, style 3, class 2, size 28 by 36 inches.
(c) Type III, size 30 by 40 inches.

The vacuum printing frames indicated below, and covered in MIL-F-3724B, were previously deleted in MIL-F-3724C.

(a) Type I, style 1, all sizes.
(b) Type I, style 2, size 25 by 27 inches.
(c) Type I, style 3, sizes 20 by 24 inches and 40 by 48 inches.
(d) Type II, sizes 40 by 48 inches, 55 by 73 inches, and 58 by 77 inches.

6.4 Radio interference suppression.- The contracting officer should submit a copy of the report required in 4.4.5 to the Commanding General, U.S. Army Electronics Command, ATTN: AMSEL-RD-GF, Fort Monmouth, New Jersey 07703, for approval.

6.5 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modification, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - PE
Air Force - 84

Review activities:

Army - ME, EL, MD

User activity:

Navy - MC

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 3610-0129

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Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

Frames, Printing, Vacuum MIL-F-3724D

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 66 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

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